

Project Consulting Report

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1. Executive Summary

The project aims to replace outdated, spreadsheet-driven recruitment processes with a cloud-native SaaS recruitment platform built on Microsoft Azure. The solution will provide end-to-end job and candidate management, AI-powered resume parsing, searchable candidate data, automated interview scheduling, and comprehensive dashboards for recruiters, hiring managers, and executives. Key decisions include using Azure AD Entra ID for SSO, .NET 8 APIs on Azure App Service, React SPA via Azure Static Web Apps, and Azure AI services for parsing and search. The recommendation is to proceed with a phased MVP that delivers core recruiting functionality within the six-month timeline while deferring advanced analytics and optional services to later phases.

2. Background Summary

The client currently manages recruitment across 35 countries with 28,000 employees using a mix of Workday, Excel, and SharePoint, resulting in fragmented data, duplicate effort, and prolonged time-to-hire. Manual processes such as resume review, interview scheduling, and status communication are causing high costs, candidate dissatisfaction, and low recruiter trust in existing systems.

3. Problem / Need Analysis

Problem / Need	Business Impact
Recruitment processes have not evolved in eight years despite growth	Inefficient hiring leads to higher operational costs, delayed time-to-fill, and lost talent.
Many teams still maintain candidate data in Excel sheets, leading to data inconsistency	Data inconsistency hampers decision-making and creates duplicate effort.
Lack of a single source of truth causes confusion when status updates	Stakeholders experience delays and mistrust, increasing time-to-hire and candidate dissatisfaction.
Recruiters use inconsistent tools (Workday, Excel, SharePoint) resulting in duplicate data	Redundant work reduces recruiter productivity and inflates hiring costs.
An engineering role remained open for three months and over 600 applications	Lost talent and prolonged vacancy drive project delays and revenue impact.
High application volume (up to 2,000 per role) forces manual resume review and overload	Review overload leads to missed strong candidates and longer hiring cycles.
Recruiters miss strong candidates because they are overwhelmed	Quality of hires declines, affecting team performance and retention.
Vacant positions, delayed hiring, and administrative work all incur significant costs	Significant financial impact through overtime, external agency fees, and lost productivity.
Recruiters do not trust the data in Workday, viewing it as a process tool	Low adoption of existing HR tools leads to parallel processes and data silos.
Repetitive tasks such as interview scheduling, resume reviewing, updating status	Administrative burden reduces time spent on strategic talent acquisition activities.
Interview scheduling currently relies on manual Outlook email coordination	Scheduling delays and errors increase time-to-hire and candidate frustration.
Candidates often feel ignored due to lack of communication during the hiring process	Negative candidate experience harms employer brand and reduces offer acceptance rates.
Concern that a new solution might be impressive but not adopted, leading to wasted investment	Failed investment and continued inefficiencies if user adoption is low.
Need to reuse existing Microsoft investments and avoid unnecessary complexity	Ensures cost-effective implementation and alignment with corporate IT strategy.

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Six-month timeline for MVP is considered ambitious and requires c Scope creep could jeopardize delivery dates and ROI expectations.

4. Requirements Analysis

Functional Requirements

ID	Requirement
FR-001	Provide job management capabilities.
FR-002	Provide candidate management capabilities.
FR-003	Allow resume upload and parsing.
FR-004	Enable candidate search across uploaded resumes.
FR-005	Offer recruiter dashboard with relevant metrics.
FR-006	Offer hiring manager dashboard.
FR-007	Automate interview scheduling.
FR-008	Send notifications to relevant users.
FR-009	Deliver analytics and reporting features.
FR-010	Support executive dashboards with metrics such as time-to-hire, time-to-fill, recruiter...
FR-011	Implement single sign-on integrated with Microsoft Entra ID.
FR-012	Record detailed audit logs of all candidate data accesses and changes.
FR-013	Enforce role-based access control with distinct permissions for recruiters, hiring mana...
FR-014	Integrate with Workday for core HR data.
FR-015	Integrate with Microsoft Teams for collaboration.
FR-016	Integrate with Outlook Calendar for interview scheduling.
FR-017	Provide a candidate portal where candidates can track applications, schedule interviews...

Non-Functional Requirements

Category	Requirement
Performance	Resume parsing must complete within 10 seconds; candidate search responses must be unde...
Scalability	System must handle peak loads of up to 2,000 concurrent applications per role and scale...
Security	All data in transit and at rest must be encrypted; Azure AD Entra ID SSO with MFA and R...
Availability	99.9% service availability using Azure Front Door and Traffic Manager across multiple r...
Maintainability	Infrastructure defined as code (Bicep/ARM) with automated CI/CD pipelines for repeatabl...

Constraints

Constraint

Business Goals

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Goal

Technology Context

Technology Context

Preferred Cloud: Azure

Existing CRM: Salesforce

5. Assumptions

Assumption

Azure subscription is available and provisioned.

Client will provide API credentials for third-party integrations.

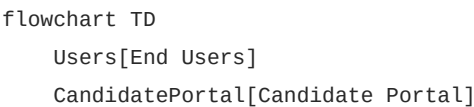
Existing infrastructure remains unchanged during the POC phase.

6. Feature & Module Breakdown

Module	Feature / Functionality	Technologies Used
Frontend	React single-page applications for recruiter and candidate portals	React SPA, Azure Static Web Apps, Azure Front Door
Backend API	RESTful services handling business logic, data validation, and orchestration	NET 6 on ASP.NET Core, Azure App Service
Database	Transactional storage for jobs, candidates, applications, audit logs	Azure SQL Database Managed Instance
Search	Semantic search over parsed resume content and candidate profiles	Azure AI Search
Storage	Secure blob storage for raw resumes and supporting documents.	Azure Blob Storage (Hot tier)
Resume Parsing	AI-driven extraction of structured candidate data from uploaded documents	Azure AI Document Intelligence (Form Recognizer)
Integration Layer	Connectivity to Workday, Outlook Calendar, Teams, and SharePoint	Azure Logic Apps + Microsoft Graph connector
Messaging Queue	Asynchronous processing of parsing jobs, notifications, and audit events	Azure Service Bus (Standard tier)
Notification Service	Real-time alerts via email, push, and Teams bot.	Azure Notification Hubs, SendGrid, Teams Bot Framework
Caching	Fast access to session state and frequently-queried reference data	Azure Cache for Redis
Monitoring & Observability	Logging, performance metrics, and audit trail collection.	Azure Monitor, Application Insights, Log Analytics
CI/CD & IaC	Automated build, test, and deployment with infrastructure as code.	Azure DevOps Pipelines, Bicep/ARM templates
Governance & Security	Secret management, policy enforcement, and optional security operations	Azure Key Vault, Azure Policy, Azure Sentinel
Analytics & Reporting	Embedded Power BI dashboards for recruiter, hiring manager, and HR	Power BI Embedded, Azure SQL

7. Final Solution Architecture

Architecture diagram source (render at mermaid.live):



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RecruiterPortal[Recruiter Portal]
CorePlatform[Core Platform]
AIEngine[AI Engine]
DataStore[Data Store]
Scheduler[Scheduler]
Analytics[Analytics]
Users --> CandidatePortal
Users --> RecruiterPortal
CandidatePortal --> CorePlatform
RecruiterPortal --> CorePlatform
CorePlatform --> AIEngine
CorePlatform --> DataStore
CorePlatform --> Scheduler
CorePlatform --> Analytics

8. Feasibility Assessment

Metric	Value	Reason
Complexity	Very High	Broad set of Azure services introduces significant implementation complexity for a
Architecture Confidence	Medium	Design is technically sound and aligns with Azure's first mandate, but integration b
Feasibility Confidence	Medium	Scope and schedule are aggressive; may exceed typical team capacity without s

9. Risk Assessment

Risk	Impact	Mitigation Strategy
Workday integration via Logic Apps may requ	Integration failures could blo	
AI-based resume parsing and Azure AI Search	Slow response times could cause delays in the	Trade recruiter productivity and candidate expe...
The extensive set of Azure services (Front D	Complex deployment pipelin	page, .
Storing candidate resumes globally may confli	Violate GDPR and other regional regulations	and loss of trust among European users.

10. Recommendations & Next Steps

Begin with a sprint's kickoff to finalize scope, confirm Azure subscriptions, and establish the core DevOps foundation (IaC, CI/CD pipelines, and Entra ID configuration). Form a cross-functional delivery team comprising a product owner, Azure-experienced architects, .NET backend developers, React front-end engineers, and a QA lead. Deliver the MVP in three incremental releases: (1) Core job and candidate data model with Azure SQL and basic CRUD APIs; (2) Recruiter portal UI, resume upload, and asynchronous parsing pipeline; (3) Interview scheduling integration with Outlook/Teams and basic dashboards. Target key milestones at the end of months 2, 4, and 6, with a go-live gate after the third release. Capture user feedback early to prioritize deferred features such as advanced AI Search and PowerBI analytics for the post-MVP roadmap.

11. Architecture Summary

The Azure-first, cloud-native architecture was chosen to leverage the client's existing Microsoft investment, meet global availability requirements, and provide a secure, compliant foundation. Azure AD Entra ID delivers unified SSO and granular RBAC, while Azure SQL Managed Instance ensures relational consistency for core HR data. AI services (Document Intelligence and AI Search) deliver the required resume parsing and semantic search capabilities, and Logic Apps orchestrate integrations with Workday, Teams, and Outlook. This combination satisfies functional and non-functional goals—performance, scalability, security, and maintainability—while aligning with budget and timeline constraints through modular, IaC-driven deployment.

12. Final Solution Architecture

Architecture diagram source (render at mermaid.live):

flowchart TD

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Users[End Users]
CandidatePortal[Candidate Portal]
RecruiterPortal[Recruiter Portal]
CorePlatform[Core Platform]
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DataStore[Data Store]
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Users --> CandidatePortal
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